

Place-Based Micropractice and Digital Placemaking

Place-Based Micropractice and Digital Placemaking I

Place-based DigiPPPiP treats the drawing context as part of the relational artifact. A shared canvas can carry marks from a kitchen table, a hospital room, a train, a park, or two distant cities. CSCW place theory distinguishes lived place from abstract space, which matters because a canvas becomes place-like only through situated practice and shared interpretation [dourish2006respace].

Place-attachment research and networked-locality and digital-placemaking scholarship show that digital media can intensify rather than dissolve place attachment when it is designed to connect people, memory, and environment [lewicka2011place; gordon2011netlocality; foth2015digitalcity; canelas2025placemaking]. The relevant unit is small: a canvas can become a relational micro-place even if it never becomes a public platform or civic interface.

Place-Based Micropractice and Digital Placemaking II

Place-responsive DigiPPPiP asks each partner to draw from their immediate environment. One partner may contribute a window view; another may respond with a local sound, map trace, color palette, or remembered path. The result is neither a private diary nor a generic online whiteboard. It is a relational place object: two embodied situations negotiated on one shared surface. Place claims should remain qualitative until participants describe particular canvases as meaningful places.

The minimum place claim requires recurrence, situated reference, and shared uptake. A one-time location tag is only metadata; a repeated drawing practice can become place-responsive when partners return to recognizable cues and use them to coordinate memory, mood, or care. This boundary keeps placemaking from becoming a decorative label for any geolocated canvas.

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A place-responsive protocol should therefore ask what place cue is being shared, who chose it, how precise it needs to be, and whether either partner wants it excluded from storage or export. The cue can be coarse: room type, local weather, a remembered path, an object on the table, a hospital routine, or a neighborhood sound. Precise global positioning system (GPS) coordinates are not required for the framework claim and may be inappropriate when the canvas is intimate, health-adjacent, or used by a vulnerable participant. The research record should preserve the prompt category and consent state without turning place into surveillance.

[@fig:relational_microplaces] maps this scale. The figure treats kitchens, studios, hospital rooms, trains, and two-city routines as contexts that can feed a persistent canvas. The point is not that a digital artifact automatically creates place attachment; it is that repeated return, situated prompts, and shared memory can make a canvas function like a small relational place.

Place-Based Micropractice and Digital Placemaking IV

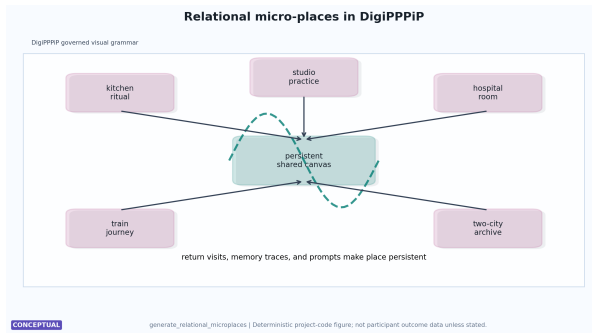


Figure 1: Digital placemaking map for recurring DigiPPPiP relational micro-places. The figure is generated by `generate_relational_microplaces()`; read the peripheral place boxes as situated contexts and the central artifact as a persistent canvas that can be revisited. It supports the place-based claim that recurrence and shared uptake matter more than geolocation alone. The diagram is conceptual and does not imply surveillance, community-scale impact, or universal place attachment.

Place-Based Micropractice and Digital Placemaking V

This place dimension is especially useful for long-distance partners and communities. A remote digital mode can support geographic reach, but place-responsive prompts keep the practice situated. The taxonomy in [fig:taxonomy_matrix] captures this as a trade-off between geographic reach and place grounding rather than a binary opposition between online and offline.